# C Y P H

şifr *(n., arabic)* — zero; the void; the origin of mathematics.

cipher *(n., cryptography)* — a code; a way of encoding meaning.

cypher *(n., music)* — a circle of voices in sequence.

**cyph *(n.)* — the new underground for ideas.**

# founders

## jalen daniels

philosopher · technologist · strategist



**alma mater**
harvard

**previous work**
ex-mckinsey

| | |
|---|---|
| startup growth | |
| institution building | |
| public intellectual | |
| inbox 0 | |
| classical ballet | |

**researching**
transhumanism · nietzsche · urban agriculture

## bryan cash

computer scientist · sports savant · optimizer



**alma mater**
syracuse

**previous work**
ex-washington post

| | |
|---|---|
| enterprise apps | |
| design engineering | |
| big data | |
| bowling | |
| chess | |

**researching**
technofeudalism · neuroathletics · molecular gastronomy

*advisory board*



**bakari kitwana**
ex-eic of the source magazine

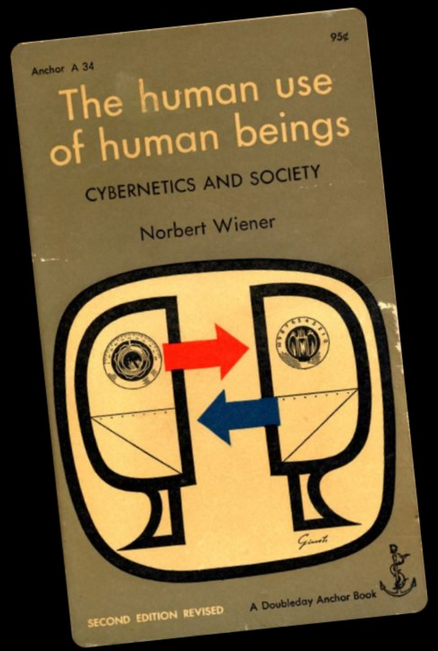


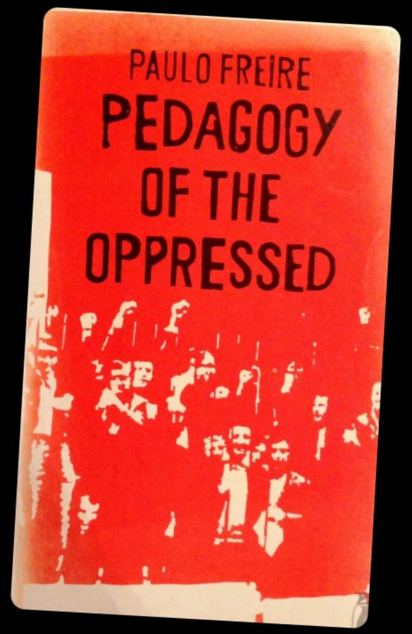
**caitlin begg**
ceo of authentic social and return to analog podcast

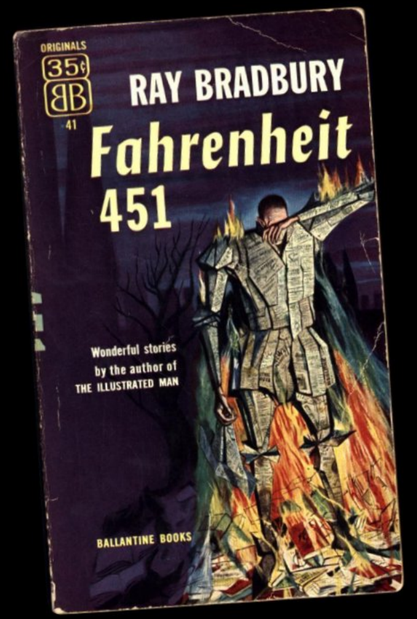


**calvary rogers**
ex-google, founder of seneca labs

# we're in an epistemic crisis.




## ai → cognitive resignation

*"your brain on chatgpt: accumulation of cognitive debt"*

mit media lab

## 'veritas' is threatened

*"college professors say their academic freedom is in decline"*

THE CHRONICLE OF HIGHER EDUCATION

## monopolized knowledge

*"anthropic destroyed millions of rare books to train their models"*

wp

# but every epistemic crisis always had an underground.



**the agora**

*athens, 500 bc*

where free thought had a home before the academy existed.



**the salon**

*paris, 1700s*

where conversations that built the enlightenment happened in living rooms.



**harlem renaissance**

*new york, 1920s*

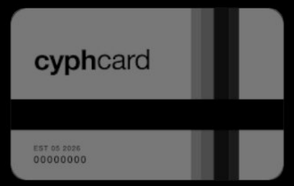
where Black intellectuals made space for possibility in the midst of danger.

# cyph is the first underground for human wisdom in the digital age.




*see trailer here*

# user journey











## 01

## underground

*where you become intellectually dangerous.*

uncover a living world of buried artifacts, rare books, and suppressed ideas — all human made.*



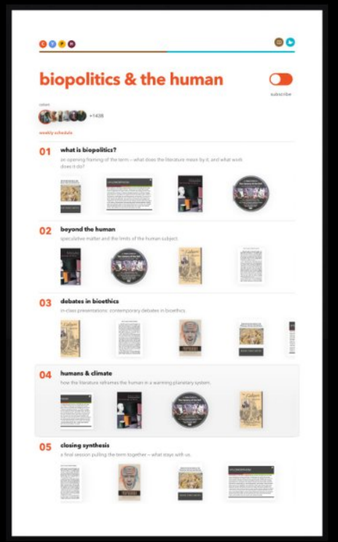
publish your own 'routes' to intellectual destinations.

**the nietzsche route**
25 stops

**the athlete as activist**
21 stops

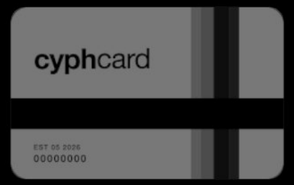
**silence as composition**
11 stops

teach a cohort learning sesh based on syllabi you design.




*seeded from open source, institutional, and personal collections.

# user journey











## 02

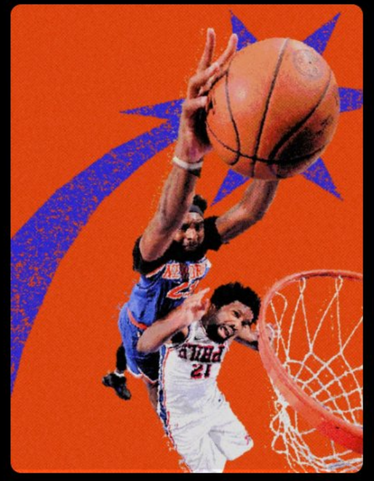
## the cyph

*where ideas get tested in real time.*

spark with thinkers around the world in real time. go deeper in office hours with underground scholars.

### live

topics sourced from API's & real-time listening.



**knicks championship**



hosted by chris robinson

### conceptual

ideas surfaced from pulses in deep research.

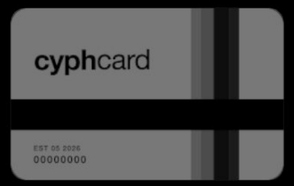


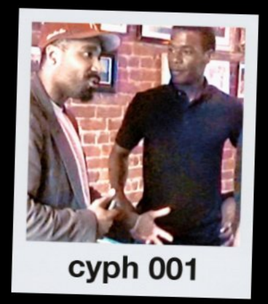
**is the soul actually cartesian?**



hosted by iain mcgilchrist

# user journey







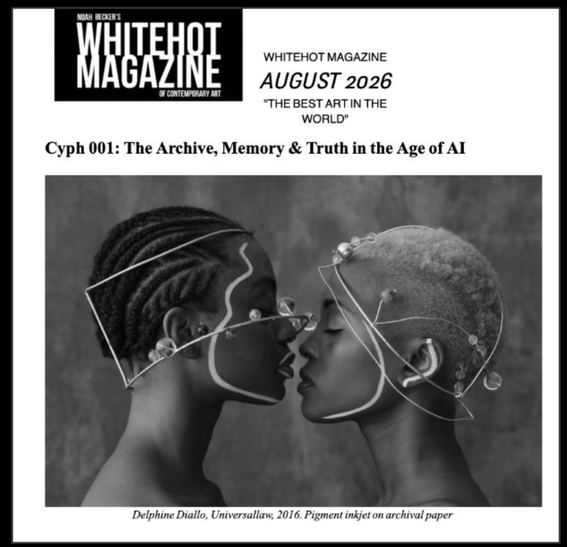

## 03

## irl

close the laptop and enter our world of IRL cyphs: lectures, office hours, supper clubs, & debates. the research from the room is archived in our partner libraries.

**our last cyph...**




**in the room**

GUGGENHEIM · OpenAI · GQ · ESSENCE · Google · STUDIO MUSEUM IN HARLEM · HBO · SQUARESPACE · DEPT · CODE AND THEORY · ISE-DA · RÉSONNER · NYC Public Schools · SUPERPOSITION · THE ROOT

**10+** residential libraries in nyc where cyph members can check out books.

# user journey









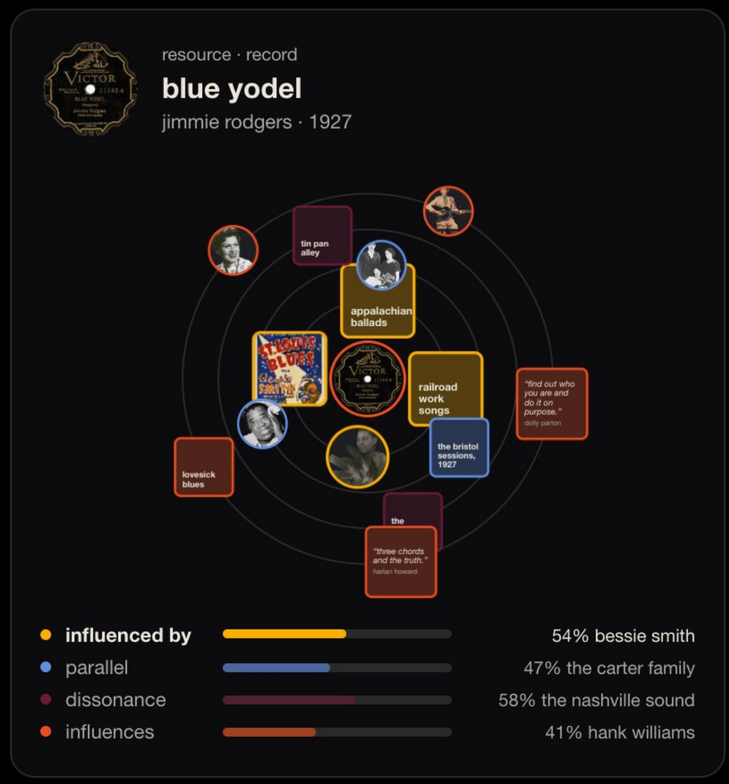


## 04

## how it all maps together

everything on cyph has its own dna. map the influence, and intersections of your ideas over time with the cyphcard.



# what real people have said.

"people are yearning to break the shackles and speak their truth."

"it encourages individuality...there's no need for an echo chamber."

"i like that it's centered around topics and things that matter rather than a sea of content."

"i love cyph because I can find actual scholars whom i would want to talk with."

"humanity needs a platform that tells them to go outside."

"the internet was built to enable resource sharing and open communication, not to suppress them."

"the world needs an ed-tech platform built by someone who knows how to resonate with culture."

"this feels like a breath of fresh air. online today is extremely gimmicky."

# let's build a cyph together.

jalen@cyph.city | bryan@cyph.city